



User 1

Has changing work shifts and wants to know spendable money before Friday.

Interview note:

"My work shifts change each week, so I want to know how much money I can spend before Friday."



User 2

Forgets bill dates and wants an early reminder.

Interview note:

"I often forget when my bills are due, so an early reminder would be really helpful."

What would make this budgeting app useful to different users?

Budgeting App Features



Manual entry



Weekly view



Bill reminders



No bank linking



Price: not set

What problem are we solving?

3 hours: 50-minute lesson, 10-minute break, 50-minute guided practice, 10-minute break, 50-minute applied practice, and 10-minute wrap-up.

SITUATION

The problem

A team is making a budgeting app but does not know what different potential users need or what might stop them from trying it. Profiles based only on age or stereotypes can produce generic messages.

TARGET

Learning goal

Use short interview evidence to build two distinct, testable customer profiles and write one relevant message for each.

Practice material: Use the practice material supplied in the session Markdown.

Use these supplied facts

Do not replace missing information with guesses.

CASE MATERIAL

Product facts

- Fictional app features are manual expense entry, a weekly spending view, and bill reminders. Bank linking is not available. The price has not been set.

CASE MATERIAL

Fictional interview notes

- "My work shifts change each week. I want to know how much I can spend before Friday."
- "I already use a spreadsheet. I would switch only if tracking takes less time."
- "I forget bill dates even when I have enough money. A reminder a few days early would help."
- "I do not want a new app to connect to my bank account."

Concepts for this problem

Keep each concept tied to the practical decision.

UNDERSTAND

Core concepts

- A customer profile summarizes a need and barrier supported by evidence. A job to be done is the progress someone seeks in a situation. Useful contrast comes from different needs or limits, not different names or ages. A message must not promise an unavailable feature.

APPLY

A simple method

- Identify what each person wants and what makes it difficult; group notes with similar needs while preserving differences; draft a message and check it against product facts and source notes.

What makes a prompt weak?

These examples come from the current session scenario.

AVOID

Weak example 1

Create two customer personas for our budgeting app.

AVOID

Weak example 2

Make both personas excited to buy and write persuasive ads.

A clearer, safer prompt

Keep the source, task, constraints, and output check visible.

USE

Improved example 1

Use only the four fictional interview notes and product facts below. Create two profiles based on different stated needs. For each, include the goal, exact supporting note, barrier, and one unanswered question. Do not infer age, income, or willingness to pay.

USE

Improved example 2

Write one short message for each profile using only available app features. Address the stated need. Do not claim bank linking or guaranteed savings. Label any untested claim as a hypothesis.

Exercise 1: Follow the steps

Use the complete case and instructions from the session Markdown.

GUIDED PRACTICE

Exercise 1: Follow the steps

- Paste the product facts and notes into AI. Run Improved Prompt 1. Check that every need points to a supplied note. Change unsupported details to unanswered questions.

Exercise 2: Try a small variation

Use the complete case and instructions from the session Markdown.

APPLIED PRACTICE

Exercise 2: Try a small variation

- Run Improved Prompt 2. Pair each message with its supporting note. Ask a classmate which message feels relevant and what remains unclear. Revise one sentence without adding unavailable features.

How to know the work is complete

Check the output before sharing or acting on it.

SUBMIT

Deliverable

- Two evidence-linked profiles and two short messages, each tied to a source note and one untested assumption.

VERIFY

Success check

- Each profile is supported by a note, and neither message promises an unavailable feature or proven outcome. #### Module 3: Hands-On Business Functions
Module 3 uses small, practical cases to study finance, operations, human resources, and privacy. Each session defines the problem first, then introduces the concepts and method students need to work with supplied materials and verify AI output.